Merit

Credit where it's due.

Peak Signal

Brandbook / Version 1.0



A precise identity for valuable relationships.

FOUNDATION

Value, recognised.

Merit makes the contribution behind an investment visible. The identity should convey the same qualities as the service: clarity, discretion and disciplined follow-through.

Premium is precision.

Not decoration. Every aligned figure, clear status and carefully phrased promise builds confidence with advisers, fund managers and family offices.

Connected	Two peaks share one structure. Relationships create the value.
Counted	The introduction has a record. Recognition is explicit.
Considered	Restrained colour, calm layouts and exact language respect the stakes.

The visual direction is approved in principle. This book defines the first detailed system, including a newly tightened mark for review.

AUDIENCE

Built for serious relationships.

The adviser is the protagonist. The fund manager buys the system. The investor should experience the fund they already trust.

01 **Advisers & family-office partners**

Need recognition, clear fee status and discretion.

Show a readable book, known terms and a visible record.

02 **Fund managers & operations**

Need control, reconciliation and distributor confidence.

Lead with attribution, payout workflow and clear responsibilities.

03 **Investors**

Need a familiar subscription experience.

Keep the manager's brand primary. Use plain language and simple account steps.

04 **Auditors & reviewers**

Need evidence and precise boundaries.

Show what can be verified, by whom, and with which access.

POSITIONING

Infrastructure with a human point.

Merit is attribution and payout infrastructure for professional fund distribution. Its emotional benefit is simple: the person who made the introduction is accounted for.

Merit

Credit where it's due.

Product

Merit owns the record and payout experience. Lead with what a person can understand and verify.

Service

Co/Unity designs and runs the programmes around Merit. Keep the service relationship separate from the product identity.

Client

Calder is a fictional fund manager in the demo. Real client portals inherit their manager's identity.

Boundary

Stellar is the network, not the Merit brand. Use a restrained factual footer mention where appropriate.

Default brand hierarchy: client brand in investor flows; Merit in adviser and fund operations; Co/Unity in the service proposal.

SIGNATURE

The compact mountain M.

Two connected peaks. One shared valley. A single snowcap cut. A confident silhouette designed to hold its own at small sizes.





Credit where it's due.

Meaning

The connected structure expresses contribution and partnership. The summit suggests earned progress, not investment performance.

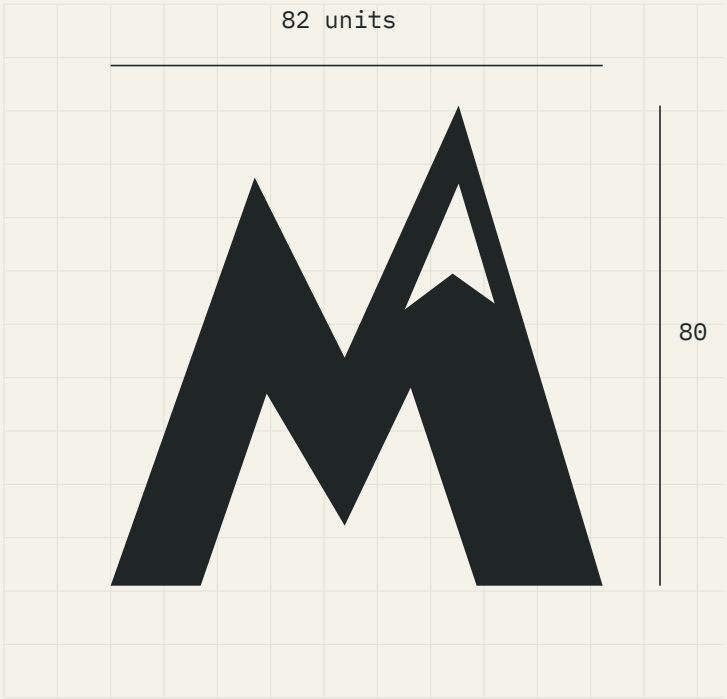
Master

Use the supplied flat SVG. Steel is an expressive rendering of the mark, never a substitute for the master artwork.

CONSTRUCTION

Space makes the mark valuable.

The visible mark is 82 units wide by 80 high. Keep its shape fixed. Do not stretch it to fill an application.



Clear space

Let H be the visible mark height. Keep at least H/4 clear on every side of a mark or lockup. The SVG viewBox padding is not the full exclusion zone.

Minimum sizes

Full snowcap mark: 32 px high / 8 mm print. Micro mark: 16-31 px high, without snowcap. Horizontal lockup: at least 110 px wide. Tagline: at least 10 px.



Use the provided micro artwork below 32 px. Verify the actual favicon at 16 px rather than shrinking a presentation render.

LOGO BEHAVIOUR

One mark. Three flat treatments.

Graphite on bone is the default. Bone on graphite is the reverse. Citron on graphite is an occasional emphasis treatment.



Primary



Reverse



Accent

Always

Use supplied vectors. Preserve the internal cut. Keep the baseline level. Place the mark on a quiet background. Use the full name beside it when introducing the brand.

Never

Stretch, rotate, outline or add peaks. Do not add gradients to the flat mark, cast a shadow in product headers, or use a scenic mountain photograph as the logo.



Use steel for covers and selected campaigns. Use flat artwork for navigation, contracts, invoices and small partner lockups.

COLOUR

Steel first. Citron as a signal.

The palette is nearly neutral. A small yellow-green accent brings contemporary energy without overwhelming the institutional tone.

Graphite
#202626
Primary text / dark canvas

Bone
#F4F2E9
Primary light canvas

Steel
#B8BFC0
Metal cues / dark-mode secondary text

Citron
#D7F45B
Selected actions / focal details

Olive
#697557
Supporting editorial tone

Stone
#DADDD3
Quiet surfaces / structure

Recommended composition



Aim for 80% graphite / bone, 15% steel / stone and 5% citron across brand compositions. These are visual proportions, not quotas for every interface.

ACCESSIBILITY

Contrast is part of the finish.

Ratios below are calculated from the exact sRGB tokens. Use 4.5:1 for normal text and 3:1 for large text and meaningful UI boundaries.

Merit / 012345	Graphite on Bone	13.70:1 / normal text
Merit / 012345	Bone on Graphite	13.70:1 / normal text
Merit / 012345	Graphite on Citron	12.43:1 / normal text
Merit / 012345	Steel on Graphite	8.23:1 / normal text
Merit / 012345	Muted on Bone	5.12:1 / normal text
Merit / 012345	Olive on Bone	4.37:1 / large text only

Do not use citron or steel for small text on bone. Citron is a fill with graphite text, or an accent on graphite. On light surfaces use #748080 for essential control borders; decorative separators may remain lighter.

Status always combines a word and a distinct icon. Never rely on colour alone. Keyboard focus: 2 px graphite ring on light surfaces; 2 px citron ring on dark, with a 2 px offset.

TYPOGRAPHY

Strong headlines. Exact figures.

Manrope gives Merit its geometric, contemporary voice. Inter carries longer reading and the interface. IBM Plex Mono is reserved for references and codes.

Merit

Manrope / 700-800

Credit where it's due.

Inter / 400, 500, 600

Clear language makes valuable relationships easier to manage. Use sentence case, generous line spacing and a deliberate hierarchy.

US$8,250.00

CALDER-PR7 / REF 0042

Display 48-64 / 1.05; page title 32 / 1.15; section 20 / 1.25; body 16 / 1.5; label 12 / 1.4. Money uses Inter 600 with tabular lining figures. Avoid letter spacing on amounts.

MATERIALS

A quiet industrial confidence.

Brushed steel communicates precision through light and surface. Use it with restraint, on a small number of high-impact brand moments.



Steel

Satin or bead-blasted finish. Fine directional grain. Narrow bevels. Neutral gray reflections. No gold, mirror chrome or liquid-metal distortion.

Light

Soft directional light with controlled highlights. Citron may appear as a fine reflected edge, never a neon halo.

Composition

One sculptural subject. Generous negative space. Crop with intention. Keep dense text away from reflections.

The cover render is an expressive image, not a fabrication drawing. Keep the flat vector silhouette as the reference for every future render.

LAYOUT & MOTION

Calm is a design decision.

Use an 8 px spacing rhythm, precise alignment and generous margins. Financial information should be easier to scan than the surrounding brand imagery.



Spacing

4 px for small internal adjustments; 8 / 16 / 24 / 32 / 48 / 64 px for layout. UI radius: 6 px controls, 10 px cards. Avoid nested card borders.

Hierarchy

One dominant message per composition. One primary action per view. Use hairline dividers, not heavy boxes. Keep money and statuses aligned.

Motion

120 ms hover, 220 ms state transition, 420 ms row arrival. Ease: cubic-bezier(.2,.8,.2,1). Move new rows at most 4 px.

Reduced motion

Remove movement and staggering when requested. No pulse loops, bouncing figures or celebratory effects around money.

VOICE

Plain. Warm. Exact.

Merit speaks like a capable partner who respects the reader's time. Confidence comes from precision, not superlatives.

Recognition

Your introduction is recorded.

Avoid: Unlock the power of your network.

Clarity

US$1,250.00 is payable.

Avoid: Rewards are coming soon.

Discretion

Your rate is between you and the fund.

Avoid: Everything is anonymous.

Honesty

Payout not sent. No money moved.

Avoid: Something went wrong.

Fixed tagline: Credit where it's due.

Use adviser, introduction, book, placement fee, vesting, payable, paid and reversed. Keep technical infrastructure language in technical and institutional material; keep adviser and investor screens familiar.

PRODUCT / LIGHT

The book is the proof.

The adviser sees recognition, progress and terms in a calm workspace. This is a designed example using fictional data, not a screenshot of shipped functionality.

Merit

Adviser book

Your view

Earned	On its way	Paid out
US$8,250.00	US$7,000.00	US$1,250.00

INTRODUCTION	YOUR FEE	STATUS
M. Ovelaran	US$1,250.00	✓ Paid
T. Brandt-Nilsen	US$5,000.00	■ Payable
Y. Harada	US$2,000.00	Vesting
H. Solberg	~~US$900.00~~	– Reversed

Illustrative data / Reversed fees excluded from totals

Make totals explainable

Earned = On its way + Paid out. Reversed amounts remain visible as evidence, but do not inflate earned totals.

Make states distinct

Vesting: clock. Payable: square or dot. Paid: check. Reversed: undo or strike-through. Every state keeps its written label.

PRODUCT / DARK

Discretion, made visible.

The public-view comparison is a signature communication device. It explains a privacy boundary without hiding the relationship itself.

Merit

Adviser book

What the world sees

Not your rate. Not what you are paid.

Attribution remains visible. Fee figures are hidden.

INTRODUCTION	YOUR FEE	STATUS
M. Ovelaran	••••	✓ Paid
T. Brandt-Nilsen	••••	■ Payable
Y. Harada	••••	◷ Vesting
H. Solberg	••••	– Reversed

Illustrative data / Reversed fees excluded from totals

Preserve meaning

Use the same layout and row order in both views. Fees become dots; labels and attribution stay visible. A view toggle is an explanation, not access control.

Preserve the boundary

Do not describe all holdings or investor flows as private. Keep authentication, permissions and backend filtering separate from the visual treatment.

APPLICATIONS

High value. Low noise.

Let the identity carry the page through proportion and material. Resist filling every surface with the mark or citron.

Merit

Recognition for the value you bring.

Attribution and payout infrastructure

Merit

Credit where it's due.

MERIT / PARTNER BRIEF

A clearer record.
A stronger relationship.

Presentation: one message per slide. Stationery: flat mark, matte stock, optional blind emboss. Digital covers: steel render and generous negative space. Never use metallic textures behind financial tables.

PARTNERSHIPS

Merit belongs at the table.

Partner materials should feel balanced and credible. Endorsement must be explicit, never implied through a decorative logo strip.



With a fund or family office

Balance optical size, not raw width. Separate marks with space or a fine divider. Preserve each brand's own clear-space requirement. Use approved partner assets only.

With Co/Unity

Merit remains the product brand. Use a factual descriptor such as: Programme design and operations by Co/Unity. Do not recolour or redraw Co/Unity to match Merit.

Investor-facing default

The fund manager owns the experience. Do not insert Merit into the core investor flow by default. An optional via Merit footer needs client agreement.

With Stellar

Use Recorded on Stellar where accurate. Use official artwork only when needed and under the current partner guidelines. Do not imply approval, certification or sponsorship.

CLAIMS & STORYTELLING

Credibility is a brand asset.

The brand can describe a future ambition. Product claims must describe the specific release being shown.

Safe working description

Merit helps fund managers and advisers track introductions and manage placement-fee payouts.

When showing the demo

Label testnet, fictional fund and illustrative data clearly. Keep stub and live demonstrations distinct.

Before claiming automation

Confirm the actual payout path, signer, scheduling and failure handling. A simulated button is not a production settlement service.

Before claiming confidentiality

Verify the deployed proof system and each visible data field. Rate privacy does not mean all activity is private.

Before claiming assurance

Do not imply regulatory approval, guaranteed returns, universal compliance or completed audits without release-specific evidence.

IMPLEMENTATION

A system the team can ship.

The visual system is captured in reusable assets and CSS tokens. Keep brand primitives separate from semantic status colours.

```
--merit-graphite: #202626;
--merit-bone:     #F4F2E9;
--merit-steel:    #B8BFC0;
--merit-citron:   #D7F45B;
--merit-olive:    #697557;
--merit-stone:    #DADDD3;
--text-muted:     #5E6868;
--border-control:#748080;
--radius-control: 6px;
--radius-card:    10px;
```

Semantic status / light

Vesting #805600 on #FFF2CC. Payable #202626 on #D7F45B. Paid #20563B on #E5F2E9. Reversed #5E6868 on #ECEFEA. Error #9D2F25 on #FDECE8.

Theme and fonts

Self-host the supplied fonts; preload only the primary face. Dark surfaces use bone and steel text. Test status and focus contrast on every actual surface.

Keep one PRODUCT.name = Merit and one fixed tagline. Use adviser on screen. Standardise Payable across docs and code. Replace the placeholder mark with the supplied SVG; keep live-data boundaries intact.

HANDOFF

One source. Consistent execution.

Use this book as the visual and verbal reference for Merit. The accompanying kit contains editable vector artwork and implementation primitives.

Identity assets

Graphite, bone and citron marks; micro marks; outlined wordmark lockups; transparent PNG previews.

Implementation

CSS tokens, machine-readable brand spec, font files and their licence texts.

Editorial source

A searchable PDF plus this guide's text in Markdown. The PDF text is selectable; the cover material is an image.

Review before rollout

Approve the exact new mark; verify trademark/name availability separately; test accessibility and real product claims against the release.

Source basis: supplied introducer-rails-main (1).zip: docs/BRAND.md, DESIGN.md, README.md, src/styles.css and StatusPill.tsx; approved moodboard direction 06; subsequent feedback favouring steel and a tighter mountain M.

Scope: identity and experience guidance. No repository code changed, no external publication and no partner endorsement implied.